Workplace Burnout and Discrimination:

Exploring the Relationship with Poor Mental Health

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DATA SCI 203 (Section 2): Lab 2
15-Apr-2025

Breaking the Silence
Mental Health, Burnout, and Discrimination at Work

Research Question:
What is the relationship between poor mental health, work-related burnout, and discrimination?

Why it Matters:
- Workplace mental health significantly impacts productivity and employee well-being.
- Understanding burnout and discrimination informs better workplace policies.

Target Audience:
Less Labor Union (LLU), a union seeking actionable insights to improve employee well-being.

Guiding Our Study
Stating The Hypothesis

H0

Null Hypothesis

Employees who work more, relax less or experience workplace discrimination will have no relationship on days of poor mental health per month.

Hypothesis

Alternative Hypothesis

Employees who work more, relax less or experience workplace discrimination will have a significant relationship with days of poor mental health per month.

H1

Data Snapshot
Who Is In Our Study?

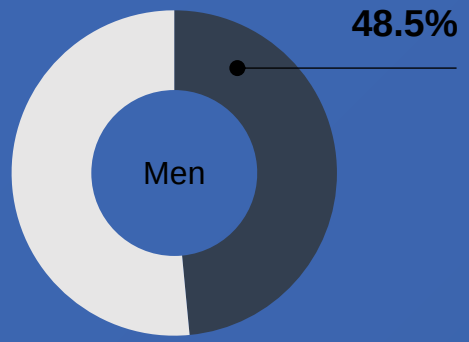
Data Source
General Social Survey (GSS) Quality of Working Life Module
Data Collected: Sep to Dec 2018

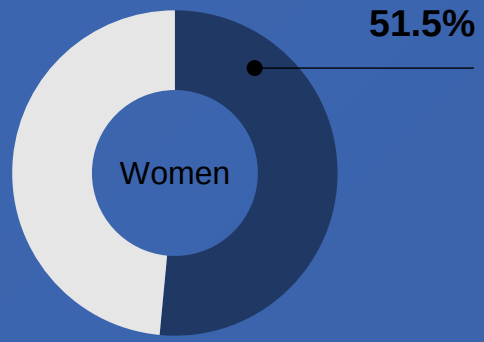
Population
U.S. Adults (Nationally Representative)
Only 1 person per household

Sample Size
Initial Entries: 2,348
Final Sample: 1,372

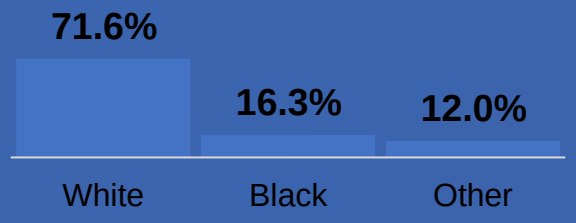
Demographic Snapshot

Gender





Race



Average Age

43.5

Seeing the Story
Key Patterns In Our Data

Race Composition Within Wealth Groups, Separated by Gender

Behind The Numbers
Operationalizing Key Concepts

DEPENDENT VARIABLE

1

Days of Poor Mental Health

Number of poor mental health days reported within the last 30 days

INDEPENDENT VARIABLES (5)

2

Stress and Burnout

1: Extra Workdays

Number of extra days worked per month

2: Relaxation Hours

Average daily hours available for relaxation

3

Discrimination

Experienced in workplace

(Yes/No)

3: Ageism

Discrimination based on age

4: Racism

Discrimination based on race

5: Sexism

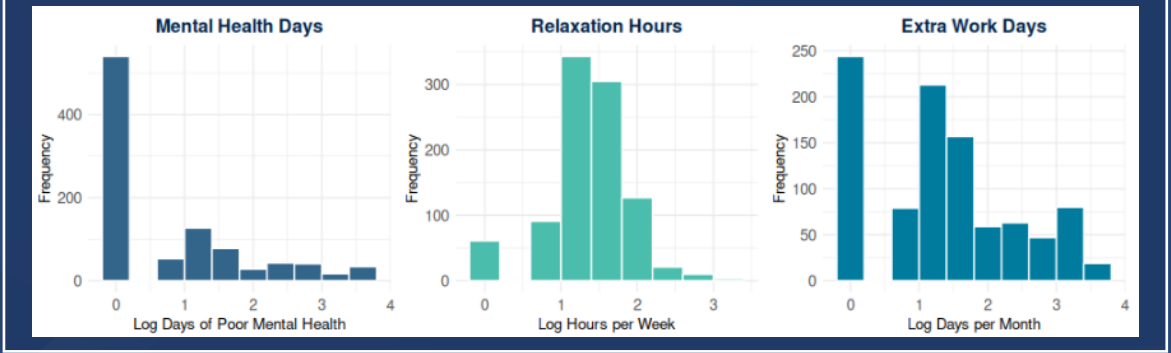
Discrimination based on gender

Seeing the Story
Key Patterns In Our Data

UNTRANSFORMED VARIABLES

- Strong right-skew metric variables

LOG-TRANSFORMED VARIABLES



- Reduced skew
- Address heteroscedasticity
- Improve model interpretability

Model Assumptions
Independent and Identically Distributed

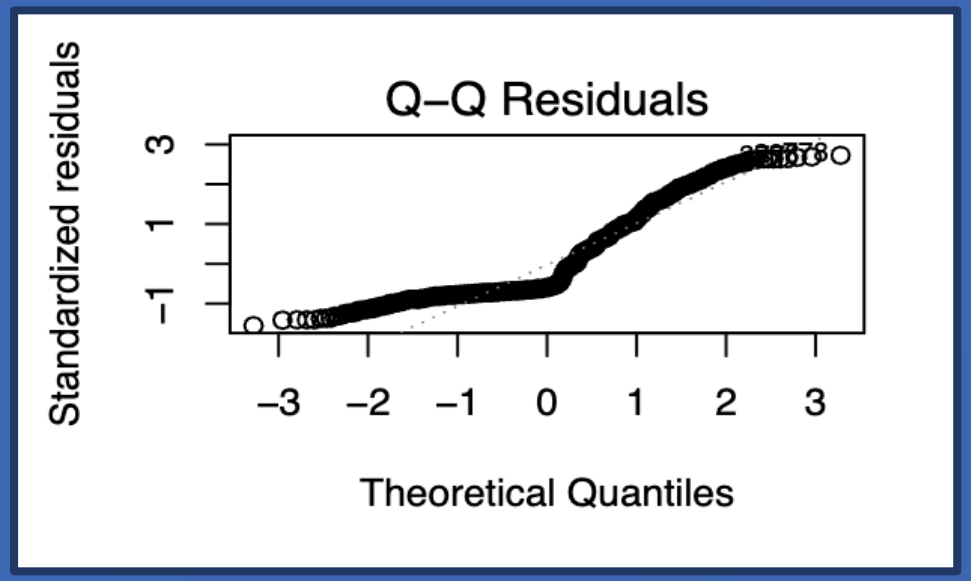
Independent and Identically Distributed

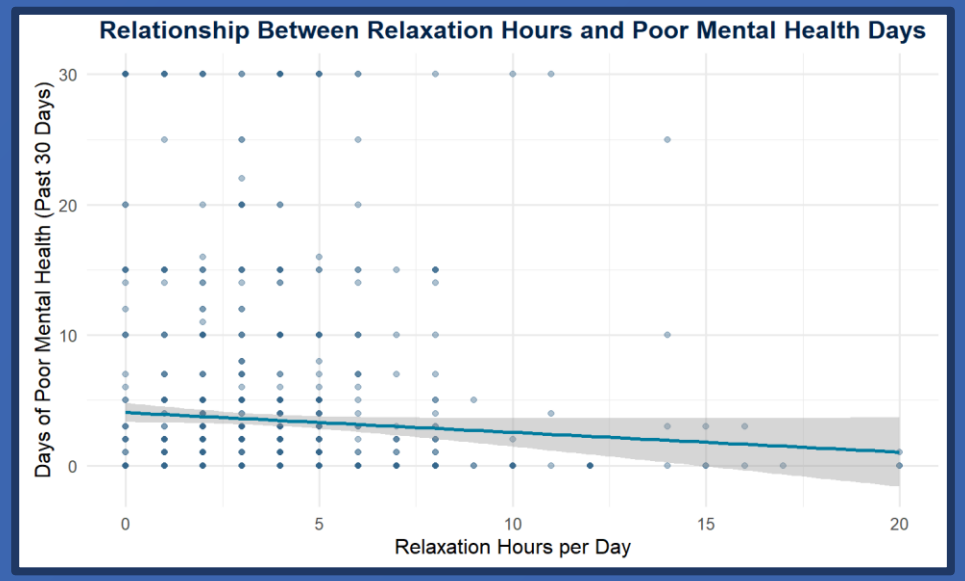
- Cross sectional and nationally representative
- GSS weighting
- Strong reputation for rigorous sampling techniques

Challenges

- Clustering
- Demographic variables not accounted for

Model Assumptions
A Unique BLP Exists





Linear

- Linear regression ran without failing

No Perfect Multicollinearity

- VIF for all variables between 1 and 1.2

Challenges

- QQ Plot
  - Leptokutotic, fat tails
- BLP may not be very good

What We Found
Our Key Findings and Results

Discrimination Experienced in Workplace

Workplace sexism → 62.4% *(p<0.01)*

Workplace ageism → 46.2% *(p<0.01)*

Workplace racism → -26.1% *(p<0.1)*

Stress and Burnout

Relaxation hours → -14.4% *(p<0.01)*

Extra workdays → not significant

Model Fit

R-square = 3.5% *(modest but expected)*

F(5,955) = 6.92 → model is statistically significant *(p<0.01)*

Calculations:
Sexism % change = (e^0.485−1)×100 = 62.4%
Ageism % change = (e^0.380−1)×100 = 46.2%
Racism % change = (e^-0.303−1)×100 = -26.1%
Relaxation Hours % change = (e^-0.155−1)×100 = -14.4%

Table 2: Regression Results – Log Transformation

	Dependent variable:
	Log(Days of Poor Mental Health + 1)
Log(Extra Work Days + 1)	0.029
	(0.033)
Log(Relaxation Hours + 1)	−0.155***
	(0.059)
Ageism Reported	0.380***
	(0.121)
Racism Reported	−0.303*
	(0.157)
Sexism Reported	0.485***
	(0.143)
Constant	0.929***
	(0.103)
Observations	961
R^2	0.035
Adjusted R^2	0.030
Residual Std. Error	1.046 (df = 955)
F Statistic	6.918*** (df = 5; 955)
Note:	*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01

THANK YOU

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